



Two vertical stones support a flat capstone.

Ancient stone circle

Stonehenge

Where Wiltshire, England

When c. 3000–2200 BCE

The purpose of this huge stone circle is a mystery, but archaeologists have discovered that some of the giant boulders at Stonehenge were dragged into place, probably on sleighs, from nearly 155 miles (250 km) away. It is believed that Stonehenge was an important religious or ceremonial site.



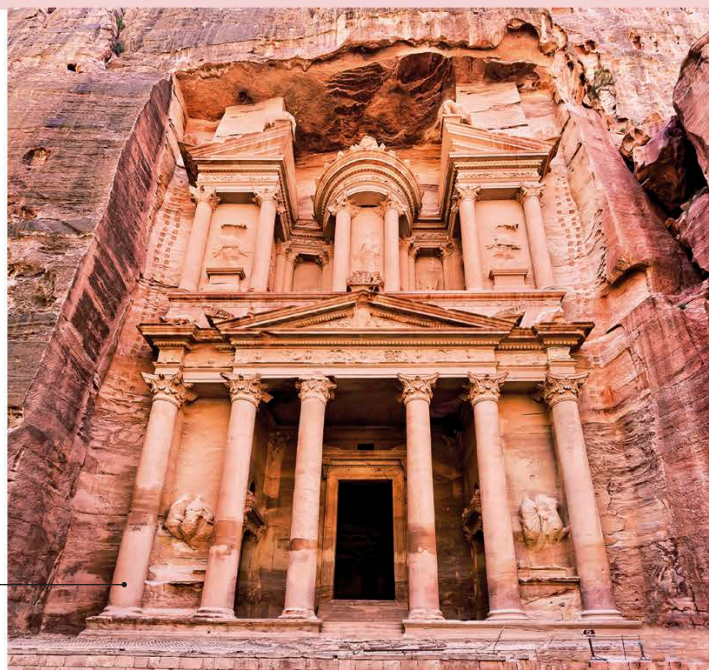
Rock-cut tomb

Al-Khazneh

Where Petra, Jordan

When Early 1st century CE

Known as Al-Khazneh ("The Treasury"), this elaborate stone monument was actually the entrance to a royal tomb. It was carved out of a sheer cliff-face by the Nabataeans—Arab traders who built their capital city of Petra in a narrow gorge in the mountains of present-day Jordan.



The columns were carved in a style similar to those found in Greek or Roman temples.

Raised circular balcony for pilgrims to walk around the stupa

One of the four gateways to the stupa



Mesoamerican step pyramid

Pyramid of the Sun



Where Teotihuacán, Mexico

When 2nd to 3rd century CE

Rising 216 ft (66 m) high, the Pyramid of the Sun was built to mimic the shape of the mountain behind it. It is the largest structure in Teotihuacán—a city in central Mexico built by a civilization that existed centuries before the Aztec Empire.

Carved obelisk

Obelisk of Aksum

Where Aksum, Ethiopia

When 4th century CE

Weighing 220 tons (200 metric tons), this tall monument is made of a single piece of granite, and stands 69 ft (21 m) high. It was built to mark the burial site of King Ezana of the ancient kingdom of Aksum (see p.45).

